

Erlang Ecosystem Foundation

Annual General Meeting

December 2024

Chair's Report



This is the 5th Annual Report for the Erlang Ecosystem Foundation.

Genesis

The Foundation officially filed its articles of incorporation as a California Nonprofit Public Benefit Corporation on Jan 19th, 2019 and it was duly registered as such on Jan 23rd, 2019. As of May 29th, 2020 we also received formal approval from the IRS as a US 501(c)(3) not-for-profit under federal tax laws.

Our Members

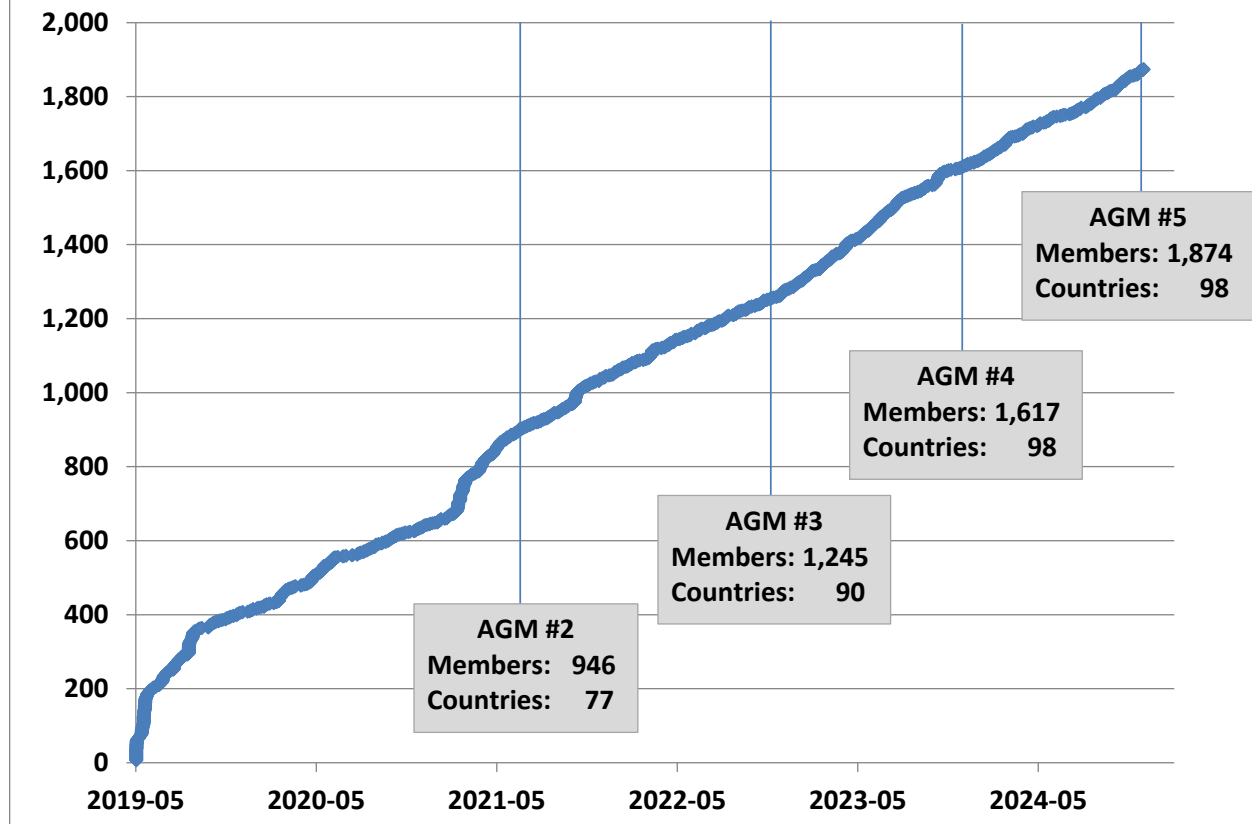
Per our charter and bylaws, we are a community benefit organization open to all persons interested in the well-being of the BEAM languages and the developers using them.

Current Members List

Summary Keyword search Advanced search Saved searches									
Level	Total	Active	Renewal overdue	Lapsed	Pending			New in last	
					New	Renewal	Level change	7 days	30 days
Annual Supporting Membership	116	116	1	-	-	-	-	-	-
Basic Membership	1712	1712	-	-	-	-	-	3	19
Board	7	7	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Fellow	2	2	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Lifetime Supporting Membership	23	23	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
Managing and Contributing	14	14	1	-	-	-	-	-	-
Total	1874	1874	2	-	-	-	-	3	19

As of the time of this report we have 1,874 members. This is an increase of 372 members or a 16% year-on-year growth since the last AGM (over the last 12 months). The community has been growing at a relatively consistent rate over the last 3 years (see graph below).

EEF Membership Growth



2023	
Rank	Country
1	United States
2	Brazil
3	Germany
4	United Kingdom
5	India
6	Canada
7	Sweden
8	Poland
9	Japan
10	Spain
11	Argentina
12	China
13	Italy
14	France
15	Netherlands
16	Australia
17	Portugal
18	Russian Federation
19	Kenya
20	Switzerland

2024	
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12	Argentina
13	China
14	France
15	Italy
16	Australia
17	Russian Federation
18	Portugal
19	Kenya
20	Switzerland

The ranking table above remains quite stable reflecting the distribution of countries population size, density of software engineers and the historic centers of Erlang's adoption around the Baltic Region and Elixir's genesis in Brazil.

The biggest mover in the last period has been the Netherlands. This relatively big jump in the rankings is probably due to the reactivation and continuing active of the local Meetup groups. Members interested in animating or starting their own local Meetup groups are encouraged to engage with the Education, Training & Adoption WG.

In regards to expanding the membership, we will continue to focus on outreach and inclusivity. Several of our working groups, especially the Marketing and Education, Training & Adoption WGs have charters and have allocated budgets to promote diversity.

Members with an interest in helping with diversity are encouraged to reach out to these two working groups.

Our Sponsors

We are grateful to our sponsors for their financial support. They are instrumental in putting the Foundation on a sound financial footing and allow us to invest in community development and future growth. At the moment we have 25 sponsors.



The Sponsorship WG continues its focus on increasing our outreach to companies and other not-for-profits in the software development space.

The biggest concern that the board has had over the last reporting period is how to grow the number of sponsors. We believe that there is some weakness in the SME space that is causing companies to be cautious with their spending, but the major impediment to fund raising is that we just need to spend more time on 'sales calls' from the Sponsorship WG perspective. I have committed to the working group to spending a lot more time on the phone talking to prospects. Any senior executives with good sales skills are invited to help. Please reach out to the working group if you think you can do sales pitches or provide contacts.

Any members working for companies who are heavy users of Elixir and Erlang are also encouraged to broker relationships with their executives and the Sponsorship WG. We are very interested in creating a virtuous circle of mutual interest and increasing the rate of the community's expansion.

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The Working Groups

At the moment, there are 13 chartered Working Groups within the EEF.
Since the last AGM there have been no changes.

The current Working Groups are:

- Marketing
- Security
- Build and Packaging
- Fellowship
- Sponsorship
- Observability
- Education, Training & Adoption
- Embedded Systems
- Infrastructure
- Language Interoperability
- External Process Communication, Interoperability & Robustness (EPC)
- Machine Learning
- Libraries & Frameworks

The present WGs are interested in more active members joining them and any member with a specific interest is encouraged to get involved.

The board continues to be open to the chartering of new WGs from members who are passionate about a specific area and are willing to self-organize.

The Education, Training & Adoption WG

As well as its traditional outreach and training activities, the WG has branched out into experimenting with ChatGPT and feeding it with 'small curated language models'. Lee Barney, has been releasing models for field trials on the Education Slack channel at an impressive rate. If members of the community are unaware of this trove of creativity, I warmly encourage members to join the Slack channel and try out some of the models. There are already stories of these GPT models being able to infer answers where there are gaps in the extant documentation and the added value of such inferences is impressive – please give them a try !



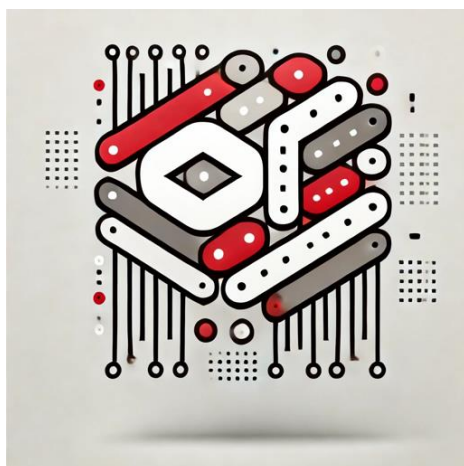
ElixirSparq



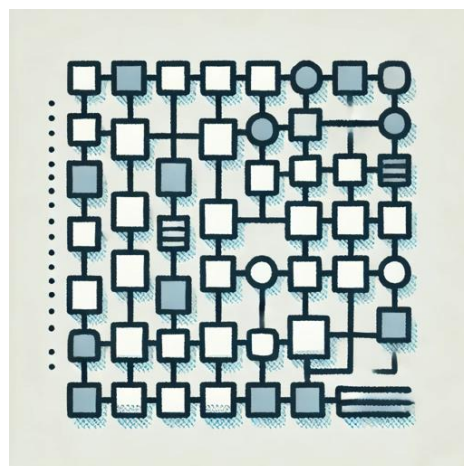
ErlangSparq



OTPSparq



OTP Dipper



Programming Patterns



Riak KV

Cybersecurity and the Security WG

For the last 12 months the board has often discussed the changes in government regulation and the increased attention being given by regulators to the topic of cybersecurity.

Here are some pointers to the changing landscape:

- https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Cyber_Resilience_Act
- https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Cybersecurity_Information_Sharing_Act
- <https://www.cisa.gov/resources-tools/resources/secure-software-development-attestation-form>
- <https://github.com/ossf/scorecard>

The board and the Security WG have and will investing time and effort to get ahead of the curve on the cybersecurity front. Here is a brief overview of the major activities this year:

- 1) Outreach to other foundations and organizations
 - a) OpenSSF
 - b) Eclipse ORC-WG
 - c) OWASP
- 2) Setting up a CVE Numbering Authority (CNA)
 - a) The EEF has brokered an agreement with Ericsson, the OTP team, Elixir Core team, Hex team and the Gleam Core team to set up a CNA to cover all Erlang, Elixir and Gleam open source projects.
 - b) Just this week, we ‘filed the paperwork’ to become a formal CNA with a CNA-root.
- 3) Raising the awareness of ‘cyber hygiene’ activities
 - a) Customizing OWASP recommendation to the BEAM environment
 - b) https://erlef.github.io/security-wg/secure_coding_and_deployment_hardening/
 - c) https://erlef.github.io/security-wg/web_app_security_best_practices_beam/



OpenRiak Status Update

Development Collaboration:

In August, the EEF gathered key developers from several companies associated with the various Riak forks. These conversations led to the group establishing a single GitHub organization, OpenRiak. The participants have identified one fork to serve as the foundation for the ongoing development, with other forks merging their improvements into the new main branch.

Recent Release:

On 9 December, the team successfully tagged their first OpenRiak release, version 3.2.3, that is now available. The team is actively preparing for the next 3.4 public release of OpenRiak.

Goals:

As part of the 3.4 release, the team has classified some features as “dark,” indicating they are soft-deprecated. They are conducting market research on the features that they will continue supporting and on the ones that are going dark to decide how to evolve. Additionally, the team is working on revising the security guides, enhancing SSL/TLS support, and creating a comprehensive guide for building OpenRiak clients.

- 2025-Q1
 - Publish a technical preview of version 3.4
 - Develop a roadmap for the next six months
 - Host OpenRiak round table at CodeBEAM America
- 2025-Q2
 - Participate in CodeBEAM Stockholm
 - Publish the version 3.4 Release Candidate
- 2025-Q4
 - Participate in CodeBEAM Europe
 - Launch the final release of version 3.4, including:
 - packages
 - new documentation
 - Some basic client

The Board

The board has held 110 meetings since the founding meeting on Thursday Feb 21, 2019.

In March and April 2024 we held our Cohort B re-election process which led to one new board member, Kiko Fernandez-Reyes, being elected. The board warmly thanks the departing board member, Sophie DeBenedetto, for her time serving on the board.

The following are the major regulatory compliance milestones that occurred between the 4th and 5th AGMs:

- 2024-11-14; 2023 IRS 990 filed online
- 2024-11-15; 2023 CA FTB 199 filed by mail

Pursuant to the EEF Bylaws the following major actions were taken:

- 2024-04 Board elections by the voting members for cohort B per Section 5.5 & 14.8
(Kiko Fernandez-Reyes, Bryan Paxton, Miriam Pena and Peer Stritzinger were duly elected).
- 2024-05 President & Secretary/Treasurer elections by the board per Section 5.5.1 & 14.8
(Sebastian Strollo (Secretary/Treasurer) and Alistair Woodman (President) were duly re-elected)
- 2024-11 The remote 5th AGM was scheduled for 2023-12-19 per Section 3.12 & 14.8

Since the last AGM, the board also approved grants and stipends requested by various WGs for following areas:

Approved Outreach Funds

- | | | |
|------------|---|----------|
| • \$ 240 | Specialized EEF-GPT | Feb 2024 |
| • \$ 2,598 | Renew sponsorship of Erlang/Elixir Forums | Mar 2024 |
| • \$ 500 | Marketing activities at Code BEAM Europe | Jul 2024 |

Approved Development Funds

- | | | |
|-------------|--|----------|
| • \$ 15,000 | OpenTelemetry Metrics and Logs | Dec 2023 |
| • \$ 300 | Registry library for the Gleam programming language | Mar 2024 |
| • \$ 2,000 | FAP1 2.0 certification | May 2024 |
| • \$ 8,000 | Hot code upgrade testing in pipeline | Jun 2024 |
| • \$ 6,000 | Verification of formal semantics of Core Erlang | Sep 2024 |
| • \$ 10,000 | Continuous profiling using OpenTelemetry eBPF profiler | Oct 2024 |

Starting in February 2021, the board also approved an ongoing budget for an external marcom agency. The resources, Nayra & El Maizal Coop, are based in Argentina and have been providing marketing communications services to the Marketing and Sponsorship WGs as well as the board.

Ongoing funding has also continued to the Infrastructure and Marketing WGs to improve the general IT infrastructure and build out the **erlef.org** website. The following features are the result of these ongoing funding

- Basic working group management tools
- Working Group report support
 - Backed by git, we'll be utilizing this abstraction for other forthcoming features
- Erlef.org email for members program
- Slack invite support for erlef, erlanger, and lfe slack
- Basic calendar integration
- Conference perk program for members
- Misc. additions and improvements
 - Security audit and improvements
 - Community page
 - Public records page
 - Fellows gallery
 - Public site analytics
 - Internal error logging and alerts
 - Object storage support for media uploads
 - General UI/UX improvements
- (in development) Job Board

Motions to the AGM:

Motion #1: The President and Secretary/Treasurer are recommending that the voting members ratify the actions of the Board and Officers of the EEF as being in the interests of the EEF and in accordance with the Bylaws.

Motion #2: The Secretary/Treasurer and President are recommending that the voting members ratify the accompanying 2024 Financial Report Document.

Looking Forward

The board is looking at several avenues for activities over the next 6-to-12 months:

1) Improved sponsorship fundraising:

All members are encouraged to get in touch with the Sponsorship WG if they are aware of companies that should be approached for sponsorship.

2) CY2025 -- a year focused on cybersecurity

The EEF will be focused on fundraising and development specifically to cover cybersecurity.

- a) Building our CVE Numbering Authority (CAN) infrastructure
- b) SBOMs
- c) Packaging and tool chain integrity.

3) More directed funding:

The board is asking the WGs to prioritize projects that they feel that the EEF should be pro-actively supporting

Best Regards

Alistair Woodman
Chair and President of the EEF